

September Check-up · Astoria · Form IB

Covers Weeks 1–4 (Sep 9 – Oct 3, 2026) · AO Year 2 Term 1 · two short sittings, about 20–30 minutes each

WHAT THIS IS

A gentle, Charlotte Mason–style “exam”: Astoria tells back what she knows, does a few sums, writes her best line, and recites. Nothing here is new material; every question comes from September’s lessons. It is *not* a graded test and there are no letter grades, percentages, or percentiles. The scores just show us, month by month, what is settling in.

DAY 1 · ABOUT 30 MIN

- Narration: Literature & Tales (L1–L4)
- Narration: History (H1–H3)
- Narration: Bible, by reference (B1–B3)
- Math: oral, then written (M1–M9)

Suggested: Friday of Week 5 (Oct 9), or any day Hallie picks.

DAY 2 · ABOUT 25 MIN

- Narration: Geography (G1–G2)
- Narration: Science & Nature (S1–S2)
- Copywork + dictation (C1, D1)
- Recitation (R1–R2)
- Riches, optional (A1–A4)

Suggested: Saturday of Week 5 (Oct 10).

SCORE	MEANS	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE
3	Confidently	On her own, in order, with real detail (names, places, what happened). Math right without help. Neat, careful letters.
2	Mostly	The main idea and some detail; a small slip or one gentle prompt (“And then?”).
1	With help	Bits and pieces, or only with several prompts or a hint. Math right only after you walk through it.
0	Not yet	Doesn’t remember it yet, or it wasn’t reached. That is fine; it just tells us what to revisit.

How to give it. Read each prompt as written, then wait. Don’t correct during a narration. Jot two or three key points she says in the score sheet’s notes column (pages 7–8), then circle 0–3. If something wasn’t actually covered, write “n/a” instead of a score. Stop early if she’s tired; finish the next day.

Bible: references only. Open your ESV to the chapter if she wants to look; no Bible text is printed here. **Tracy (2):** no check-up; she may sit nearby with crayons or McGuffey pictures and join the songs.

Day 1 · Narration

ABOUT 15 MIN · ORAL · HALLIE JOTS KEY POINTS

LITERATURE & TALES

- L1 The Little Duke** 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
Tell me about Richard. Who is he, where did he live, and what happened to his father?
Listen for: Bayeux, Fru Astrida, William Longsword, the treacherous meeting, Richard becoming Duke, the ride into Rouen.
-
- L2 Understood Betsy** 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
Tell me about Elizabeth Ann. Why did she leave her aunts, and what was new for her at Putney Farm?
Listen for: the aunts, the trip, the Putney cousins, doing things for herself.
-
- L3 Pilgrim's Progress** 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
What happened when Christian came to the Slough of Despond?
Listen for: the burden, the wicket-gate, Pliable turning back, Help pulling him out.
-
- L4 The Wind in the Willows** OPTIONAL · FINISHED BOOK 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
Tell me about Mole in the Wild Wood. Who found him, and where did they go?
Listen for: lost in the snow, Rat comes, Mr. Badger's home.
-

HISTORY

- H1 Our Island Story · Hastings** 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
Tell me what happened at the Battle of Hastings.
Listen for: Harold, William of Normandy, 1066, the arrow, William becoming king.
-
- H2 Our Island Story · Hereward** 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
Tell me about Hereward the Wake.
Listen for: hiding in the fens, fighting the Normans, how he was betrayed.
-
- H3 A Child's History of the World** HILLYER 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
Tell me about Charlemagne, or about the people who thought the world would end.
Listen for: Charlemagne's empire; the year 1000; Vikings / Leif. (Either one counts.)
-

BIBLE · BY REFERENCE ONLY (ESV)

- B1 Exodus 3** 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
Tell what happened at Exodus 3.
Listen for: who, where, what God told him to do.
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- B2 Exodus 12** 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
Tell what happened at Exodus 12.
Listen for: what each family did, and what happened that night.
-
- B3 Luke 19:1–9** 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
Tell what happened at Luke 19:1–9.
Listen for: who, why he climbed, and what changed for him.
-

Day 1 · Math

ABOUT 12–15 MIN · ORAL FIRST, THEN WRITTEN

Original problems in the range of Ray’s New Practical Arithmetic Lessons 1–8 (reading and writing numbers, place value, Roman numerals, adding). If your copy hadn’t reached a skill by Lesson 8, write “n/a”. Don’t score it 0.

ORAL · SHE ANSWERS ALOUD (HALLIE WRITES THE NUMBERS ON A CARD FOR M1)

M1	Reading numbers	0 · 1 · 2 · 3
	Point to each and ask her to read it aloud: 48 · 306 · 570 · 1,204 <i>Listen for: says each number correctly; zeros handled (“three hundred six”).</i>	
M2	Place value	0 · 1 · 2 · 3
	In the number 463 , how many hundreds? How many tens? How many units (ones)? <i>Listen for: 4 hundreds, 6 tens, 3 units.</i>	
M3	Adding facts	0 · 1 · 2 · 3
	7 + 5 · 8 + 6 · 9 + 4 · 6 + 7 · 9 + 9 , said quickly, one at a time <i>Listen for: 12, 14, 13, 13, 18; quick recall vs. counting on fingers (note which).</i>	
M4	Story sum	0 · 1 · 2 · 3
	Astoria picks 9 pecans before lunch and 7 after lunch. How many pecans does she have? <i>Listen for: 16, and can she say how she knew.</i>	
M5	Story sum	0 · 1 · 2 · 3
	A hen house has 20 hens. Papa brings home 12 more. Then 5 chicks hatch. How many birds now? <i>Listen for: 37; keeps track of two steps.</i>	

WRITTEN · ON PAGE 6 (ASTORIA’S PAGE)

M6	Write in figures	0 · 1 · 2 · 3
	Hallie says: “two hundred fifty-three” and “four hundred eight.” Astoria writes the numbers. <i>Listen for: 253 and 408 (watch the zero).</i>	
M7	Roman numerals	0 · 1 · 2 · 3
	Write as Roman numerals: 3, 6, 9, 14. Then read XII and XX . <i>Listen for: III, VI, IX, XIV; twelve, twenty.</i>	
M8	Column adding	0 · 1 · 2 · 3
	Add: 324 + 152 and 41 + 23 + 15 <i>Listen for: 476 and 79; lines digits up in columns.</i>	
M9	Adding with carrying ONLY IF COVERED	0–3 or n/a
	Add: 58 + 27 and 146 + 38 <i>Listen for: 85 and 184; carries the ten.</i>	

Day 2

ABOUT 25 MIN IN ALL · NARRATION, HANDWRITING

GEOGRAPHY

- G1 Compass** 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
- Stand by the front door. Show me north, south, east, and west. How can you tell?
Listen for: points correctly; uses the sun (rises in the east) or a compass.
-
- G2 Tree in the Trail** 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
- Tell me about the little tree in Tree in the Trail. Where did it grow, and who passed by it?
Listen for: the lone sapling on the plains, buffalo, people passing.
-

SCIENCE & NATURE

- S1 Burgess Animal Book** 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
- Tell me about Peter Rabbit's school with Old Mother Nature. Which animals did you learn about?
Listen for: Jenny Wren's idea, Peter's long-legged cousins, Chatterer and Happy Jack.
-
- S2 Nature walks** 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
- Tell me about a small creature you found on our walks in the Lost Pines. What did it look like and what was it doing? (She may draw it.)
Listen for: her own observation: color, legs, where, behavior.
-

COPYWORK & DICTATION

- C1 Copywork · best handwriting** 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
- On page 6, copy once, slowly: the two lines from *Silver* (de la Mare) printed there.
Listen for: letters formed well, sits on the line, spaces between words, capitals and punctuation copied.
-
- D1 Dictation · prepared** 0 · 1 · 2 · 3
- Let her study the *Some One* lines on page 6 for a minute, then cover them. Read them aloud once, slowly; she writes from your voice.
Listen for: words spelled right, capitals, commas, the semicolon. Count slips in the notes.
-

RECITATION

- | | | |
|-----------|---|---------------|
| R1 | Genesis 1:1 <small>ESV · REFERENCE ONLY</small>
Please say Genesis 1:1.
<i>Listen for: word-perfect from memory, clear voice.</i> | 0 · 1 · 2 · 3 |
| <hr/> | | |
| R2 | A September poem
Say any September poem you know: <i>Silver, The Cupboard, Some One, or Tired Tim</i> (a stanza is fine).
<i>Listen for: which poem, how far, with expression.</i> | 0 · 1 · 2 · 3 |

RICHES · OPTIONAL · DESCRIBE FROM MEMORY

- | | | |
|-----------|--|---------------|
| A1 | Picture study
Without looking: tell me about Rockwell's <i>Freedom of Speech</i> . Who is in it and what is happening?
<i>Listen for: the standing man, the people looking up, the meeting.</i> | 0 · 1 · 2 · 3 |
| <hr/> | | |
| A2 | Composer
Tell me about the Bernstein music we listened to (<i>Jeremiah</i>). How did it sound or make you feel?
<i>Listen for: her own words: slow, sad, loud, a singer.</i> | 0 · 1 · 2 · 3 |
| <hr/> | | |
| A3 | Hymn
Sing the first stanza of "I Bind Unto Myself Today."
<i>Listen for: words and tune.</i> | 0 · 1 · 2 · 3 |
| <hr/> | | |
| A4 | Folk song
Sing what you know of "The Bold Grenadier."
<i>Listen for: words and tune.</i> | 0 · 1 · 2 · 3 |

My September Check-up

M6 · WRITE THE NUMBERS YOU HEAR

M7 · ROMAN NUMERALS

3	6	9	14
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M8 · M9 · ADD

M8 A 324 + 152 -----	M8 B 41 23 + 15 -----	M9 A 58 + 27 -----	M9 B 146 + 38 -----
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C1 · COPYWORK: COPY THESE TWO LINES SLOWLY

Slowly, silently, now the moon
Walks the night in her silver shoon:
— Walter de la Mare, “Silver”

D1 · DICTATION: STUDY, THEN MAMA COVERS THIS AND READS IT TO YOU

Some one came knocking
At my wee, small door;
— Walter de la Mare, “Some One” (fold this strip under before writing)

September Check-up · Score Sheet

Date(s) given: _____ · Given by: Hallie · Circle 0–3 (or write n/a). Notes = two or three key points she said, or what tripped her up.

ITEM	SCORE	NOTES
LITERATURE & TALES		
L1 Little Duke	0 1 2 3	
L2 Understood Betsy	0 1 2 3	
L3 Pilgrim's Progress	0 1 2 3	
L4 Wind in the Willows (opt.)	0 1 2 3	
Literature & Tales total	___ / 12	n/a items: subtract 3 each from the max
HISTORY		
H1 Hastings	0 1 2 3	
H2 Hereward	0 1 2 3	
H3 Hillyer (CHOW)	0 1 2 3	
History total	___ / 9	n/a items: subtract 3 each from the max
BIBLE (BY REFERENCE)		
B1 Exodus 3	0 1 2 3	
B2 Exodus 12	0 1 2 3	
B3 Luke 19:1–9	0 1 2 3	
Bible (by reference) total	___ / 9	n/a items: subtract 3 each from the max
MATH		
M1 Reading numbers	0 1 2 3	
M2 Place value	0 1 2 3	
M3 Adding facts	0 1 2 3	
M4 Story sum	0 1 2 3	
M5 Two-step story	0 1 2 3	
M6 Write in figures	0 1 2 3	
M7 Roman numerals	0 1 2 3	
M8 Column adding	0 1 2 3	
M9 Carrying (if covered)	0 1 2 3	
Math total	___ / 27	n/a items: subtract 3 each from the max

Score Sheet (continued)

ITEM	SCORE	NOTES
GEOGRAPHY		
G1 Compass	0 1 2 3	
G2 Tree in the Trail	0 1 2 3	
Geography total	___ / 6	n/a items: subtract 3 each from the max
SCIENCE & NATURE		
S1 Burgess	0 1 2 3	
S2 Nature walk	0 1 2 3	
Science & Nature total	___ / 6	n/a items: subtract 3 each from the max
LANGUAGE ARTS		
C1 Copywork	0 1 2 3	
D1 Dictation	0 1 2 3	
Language Arts total	___ / 6	n/a items: subtract 3 each from the max
RECITATION		
R1 Genesis 1:1	0 1 2 3	
R2 Poem	0 1 2 3	
Recitation total	___ / 6	n/a items: subtract 3 each from the max
RICHES (OPTIONAL)		
A1 Picture study	0 1 2 3	
A2 Composer	0 1 2 3	
A3 Hymn	0 1 2 3	
A4 Folk song	0 1 2 3	
Riches (optional) total	___ / 12	n/a items: subtract 3 each from the max

SEPTEMBER SUMMARY	TOTAL	MAX (MINUS N/A)
Literature & Tales	___	___ / 12
History	___	___ / 9
Bible (by reference)	___	___ / 9
Math	___	___ / 27
Geography	___	___ / 6
Science & Nature	___	___ / 6
Language Arts	___	___ / 6
Recitation	___	___ / 6
Riches (optional)	___	___ / 12

No letter grades, no percentages. Wren records each subject total next to last month’s so the trend shows over the year.

Scoring Guide & Sending Scores

KIND	3 · CONFIDENTLY	2 · MOSTLY	1 · WITH HELP	0 · NOT YET
Narration	Tells it in order, on her own, with names and real detail	Main events, some detail, one prompt	Fragments, or needs several prompts	Can't recall it yet
Math	Right, without help; facts quick	Right with one slip she fixes, or slow counting	Right only after you walk through it	Not yet, or wrong
Copywork	Careful letters, on the line, spaced, every mark copied	Mostly neat; a few letters off	Finished, with many corrections or your help	Not yet able
Dictation	No slips	1–2 slips	3–5 slips, or needed it read more than twice	More than 5 slips
Recitation	Word-perfect, clear voice	One or two small slips	Needs prompting to get through	Not yet memorized
Riches	Describes or sings it with detail	Some detail or most words	A little, with prompts	Doesn't recall yet

SEND THE SCORES (BY SAT OCT 10 IF YOU CAN)

- Photo of the score sheet (pages 7–8) and Astoria’s page (page 6), **or**
- Type them in chat to Wren, e.g. “L1 3, L2 2, ... notes: ...”
- Skipped anything? Write n/a. Fine to send a partial sheet.

WHAT HAPPENS WITH THEM

- Wren files them in the kids’ education notebook.
- Each month’s totals go on Astoria’s trajectory, so we can see the trend.
- Low items become next month’s review ideas, never extra drills.

Not a standardized test. These are home check-ups written from our own lessons. They show Astoria’s own trend over the year. They can’t be turned into percentiles or compared with Texas or national averages. For that, the plan is one nationally normed test at the end of the school year (spring 2027).

Next check-up: October (Weeks 5–8), sent with the first packet of November. Same format, same 0–3 scale.